

SARA TARIQ

United States (Open to Relocation) | F-1 STEM OPT Eligible (Work Authorized Nationwide)
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Project manager with 5+ years driving cross-functional delivery for Fortune 500 clients across manufacturing, consumer goods, and energy services. Skilled in Agile program execution and data analytics tools including SQL, Python, and Power BI, with hands-on experience applying AI-driven tools to strengthen forecasting and decision-making. Known for organized execution, clear stakeholder communication, and translating complex data into actionable strategy.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cummins West Lafayette, IN
Sep 2026 – Present
Portfolio Project Manager (Portfolio Teaching Assistant), Analytics & AI, The Data Mine, Purdue

- Guiding a 10 use case enterprise AI portfolio across 4 project divisions for Cummins' Analytics and Artificial Intelligence group as the primary point of contact between Purdue and Cummins, owning portfolio governance, delivery cadence, and escalation paths.
- Translating business unit requirements into scoped technical workstreams for 10 use cases spanning agentic AI observability, CI/CD automation with persistent-memory agents, asset-based diagnostics optimization, and AI-enabled compliance automation on Databricks, Snowflake, Palantir, and Azure.

Kearney United States (Remote)
Jan 2026 – Present
Analytics Project Lead (Analytics Consultant), PepsiCo Engagement, Purdue Practicum

- Redirected multi-million-dollar repair-versus-replace decisions across a 30K+ unit fleet by building a KPI baseline from 150K+ service work orders in SQL, surfacing OEM underperformance and a diagnostic miss rate escalated to senior leadership.
- Delivered every phase of a multi-phase PepsiCo engagement on schedule by directing a cross-functional consulting team alongside Kearney advisors, owning scope definition, meeting cadence, action tracking, and risk escalation through executive readouts.

Purdue Research Foundation, Office of Investments West Lafayette, IN
Aug 2025 – Present
Project Manager (Coordination Lead), The Data Mine, Purdue

- Automating the Office of Investments' manual investment reporting across 5 sub-teams (Database, Parsing, API, Front End, Finance) by establishing the operating cadence, requirements documentation, and dependency reviews.

LearnOBots Islamabad, Pakistan
May 2022 – Nov 2024
Senior Business Analyst (Senior Business Development Officer)

- Redirected quarterly go-to-market strategy across 78+ converted accounts and \$250K+ in revenue by owning delivery of the customer profitability and program-ROI analysis and the conversion metrics behind it.
- Lifted capacity planning accuracy by 30% across 3 program lines by delivering a demand forecasting model, and led the automation of recurring commercial reporting with Excel pivot models and VBA.

Metro Security Pvt. Ltd. Islamabad, Pakistan
Apr 2019 – Jul 2021
Business Analyst (Business Development Officer)

- Cut bid-preparation time by 40% and supported bid wins exceeding \$1.2M with Coca-Cola Pakistan and British American Tobacco by building Excel cost models with scenario toggles that standardized RFP and RFQ pricing across a Fortune 500 tender pipeline.

Schlumberger (SLB) Islamabad, Pakistan
Jun 2017 – Sep 2017
Procurement Analyst Intern (Supply Chain & Procurement Intern)

- Supported data-driven vendor selection for a global oilfield services operation lacking competitive benchmarking by analyzing multi-vendor sourcing data and evaluating supplier capabilities against technical and commercial criteria. Protected on-time delivery of critical materials and reduced supply risk exposure by building stock, order, and lead-time models to forecast demand.

British American Tobacco Islamabad, Pakistan
Jun 2015 – Oct 2015
Talent Acquisition Analyst (Senior Sourcing Officer)

- Delivered 40 assessment centres, training programs, and campus career fairs end-to-end by streamlining an early careers recruiting function previously reliant on manual workflows, and defined requirements and evaluated vendors for a centralized candidate database built with an external provider.

EDUCATION

Purdue University, Mitchell E. Daniels Jr. School of Business West Lafayette, IN
Aug 2025 – Dec 2026
M.S. Business Analytics & Information Management, Information Management Specialization (STEM)

Relevant Coursework: IT Project Management, AI for Business, Foundations of Artificial Intelligence, Spreadsheet Modeling & Monte Carlo Simulation, Statistical Modeling, SQL for Analytics, Machine Learning, Data Management

National University of Sciences and Technology (NUST) Islamabad, Pakistan
2015 – Dec 2017
Master of Business Administration (MBA)

PROJECTS

E-Commerce Price Dynamics

- Quantified which technical specifications drive market valuation across 100,000+ product records by running statistical hypothesis tests in Python (Pandas, NumPy), producing evidence-based pricing and positioning recommendations.

Financial Risk Prediction

- Reached AUC 91.7% on severely imbalanced financial data by building an XGBoost and LightGBM ensemble in Python with SMOTE resampling and L1/L2 regularization, and ranked the top risk drivers behind each score.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Project & Program Delivery:** Program Governance, End-to-End Delivery, Scope & Requirements Definition, Schedule Management, Dependency and Risk Management, Stakeholder Management, Executive Reporting, Agile & Scrum, Jira, Microsoft Project.
- Delivery Methods & Business:** KPI Definition, Business Case & ROI Analysis, Go-to-Market Planning, Vendor & Contract Management, Process Improvement, Cross-Functional Team Leadership, Forecasting, Scenario Analysis.
- Technical & Analytics:** SQL (joins, CTEs, window functions), Python (Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn), Power BI (DAX), Tableau, Advanced Excel (Power Pivot, VBA), Databricks, Azure, Predictive Modeling.
- Awards & Certifications:** CAPM (PMI), Microsoft Power BI Data Analyst Associate (PL-300), Microsoft Azure AI Fundamentals (AI-900), Edelman Award Winner (Kearney x PepsiCo).